



Disaster Risk Reduction and Climate Change Adaptation Budget Tagging

Mauritius Country Report

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For additional information, please contact:

United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR)

7bis Avenue de la Paix, CH1211 Geneva 2, Switzerland, Tel: +41 22 917 89 08

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Abbreviations

AFD	Agence Française de Développement (French Development Agency)
CCA	climate change adaptation
DAC	Development Assistance Committee
DCBT	disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation budget tagging
DRM	disaster risk management
DRR	disaster risk reduction
DRRM	Disaster Risk Reduction and Management
GBT	green budget tagging
GDBT	green and disaster budget tagging
GDP	gross domestic product
IIED	International Institute for Environment and Development
MLGDRM	Ministry of Local Government and Disaster Risk Management
MUR	Mauritian rupee
NAP	National Adaptation Plan
NDC	Nationally Determined Contribution
NDRRMC	National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Centre
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
SMEs	small and medium enterprises
TPSEE	Tracking Public Sector Environment Expenditure project
UNDP	United Nations Development Programme
UNDRR	United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction
UNISDR	United Nations International Strategy for Disaster Reduction

1 Introduction

The Ministry of Finance is leading the reform process in Mauritius to institutionalize green budget tagging (GBT). The United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR) and the International Institute for Environment and Development (IIED) through the Resilience Building and Disaster Response Management in the Indian Ocean programme, have been providing support to the Ministry of Finance on how disaster risk reduction (DRR) and climate change adaptation (CCA) can be better coordinated and integrated into national budgeting and financing processes. A detailed terms of reference for the project Strengthening Disaster Risk Reduction and Climate Change Adaptation Tagging, Tracking and Monitoring in Mauritius was developed with the Ministry of Finance, outlining the scope of support from UNDRR and IIED, the methodology and key deliverables. Project activities officially started following approval in July 2024.

Building on previous reforms on DRR and climate change expenditure tagging in Mauritius, the project supported the piloting of a combined disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation budget tagging (DCBT) system for the budget period 2023–2024 and 2024–2025. As part of the process, a mission by the project team to Port Louis was held in August 2024. This included capacity-building and awareness-raising on integrated budget-tagging approaches. Working sessions were held with key DRR and CCA spending ministries,

where the project team presented the DCBT methodology and together with officials applied the methodology for the expenditure analysis using the approved national budget. In addition, the consultations provided important insights into practical measures that can be used to integrate DCBT as part of the annual budget process. Over 180 officials were engaged as part of the consultation process.

This report contains the key findings and recommendations from piloting DCBT in Mauritius. The outcome from the analysis will be used to inform how DRR can be integrated into the ongoing GBT reform, to create green and disaster budget tagging (GDBT).¹ Section 2 provides an overview of the policy and institutional landscape for DRR and CCA, followed by Section 3 which considers previous and current reforms introduced to support the monitoring and reporting on public DRR and CCA expenditure. Section 4 provides an overview of the DCBT methodology and scope of the expenditure analysis. The key findings are presented in Section 5, while Section 6 outlines plans to institutionalize GDBT as part of the annual budget process. This will be informed by the green budget tagging roadmap and guidelines developed by the Ministry of Finance with support from the French Development Agency (Agence Française de Développement or AFD) and UNDRR.

1 The GBT reform is supported by Agence Française de Développement (AFD).

2

Policy and institutional landscape for disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation

Mauritius is vulnerable to the impacts of climate change and a significant number of disasters in the country are climate related.

The Mauritius National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Strategic Framework for 2020–2030 identified at least 41 hazards, which include hydro-meteorological, environmental, biological, chemical, geological and technological hazards (MLGDRM, 2020). The most common type of disasters are climate-related events and include cyclones, torrential rains, flooding and wildfires (ibid). In addition, Mauritius is vulnerable to climate-related slow-onset events, including rising temperatures and sea-level rise.

Within this context, Mauritius has introduced policies and institutional arrangements to strengthen and coordinate the national response to DRR and CCA.² The main policy frameworks for DRR and CCA are presented in Table 1. For a more detailed overview of the policy and institutional arrangements for DRR in Mauritius, please see the recent mapping developed by UNDRR (2024).

There are largely separate institutional and coordination arrangements in place for DRR and CCA. The National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) Act of 2016

established governance and coordination arrangements for DRR (Government of Mauritius, 2016). This includes:

- The **National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council**, which develops and oversees the implementation of the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Policy, as well post-disaster recovery and reconstruction activities.
- The Act designates the **National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Centre (NDRRMC)** as the main institution coordinating and monitoring the implementation of DRR and management activities as per national frameworks and plans. The NDRRMC has a role in collaborating with all relevant stakeholders and supporting government ministries, departments and agencies, as well as local authorities and communities in building capacity for DRRM.
- The **National Crisis Committee** is responsible for ensuring the activation of the general preparedness plans at all levels, evacuation measures for people at risk, supervision of the disaster response operations, providing relief assistance and taking appropriate measures during the initial recovery phase.

2 Mauritius has also introduced measures to address climate change mitigation which are not covered in this report.

- The **National Emergency Operations Command** is activated in the event of a disaster to coordinate and monitor all response and recovery activities. It reports to the National Crisis Committee.
- The **Disaster Response Unit** is composed of police officers and situated within the Special Mobile Force. It provides assistance in disaster response operations to the National Emergency Operations Command, local emergency operations commands and the Rodrigues Emergency Operations Command.

An overview of the functions and composition of the various DRR coordination mechanisms described above is provided in Appendix 4.

For coordinating the response to climate change, institutional arrangements are established by the Climate Change Act of 2020 (Government of Mauritius, 2020). This includes the **Inter-Ministerial Council on Climate Change**, which is represented by at least 23 ministers from across government.³ It sets national climate policies and priorities, monitors the progress made by government departments on climate change projects and programmes, and ensures coordination and cooperation

between all relevant stakeholders, including government departments, local authorities and other organizations.

The **Department of Climate Change** within the Ministry of Environment, Solid Waste Management and Climate Change, is the lead agency developing, coordinating and monitoring CCA and mitigation policies. It is also responsible for establishing reporting mechanisms for public and private institutions, developing guidelines, building capacity and promoting the participation of various state and non-state stakeholders in the response to climate change. The Act also makes provisions for the **Climate Change Committee**, which works at the technical level and has representatives from across government.⁴ It is mainly concerned with reporting under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) process and coordinating the implementation of CCA and mitigation measures, taking into consideration human rights and vulnerable communities. The Climate Change Committee is required to periodically report (every two years) to the Minister of Environment, Solid Waste Management and Climate Change.

3 This includes ministers responsible for agriculture, energy, blue economy, commerce, education, environment, foreign affairs, health, housing and lands, industry, gender equality, labour, land transport, public utilities, national infrastructure, tourism, social security and national solidarity, youth and sports, local government, outer islands and Rodrigues.

4 Membership to the climate change committee consists of representatives from the ministries responsible for agro-industry and food security; education, tertiary education, science and technology; energy and public utilities; environment; finance, economic planning and development; gender equality and family welfare; health and wellness; housing and land-use planning; industrial development, small and medium enterprises (SMEs) and cooperatives; land transport and light rail; local government and disaster risk management; blue economy, marine resources, fisheries and shipping; national infrastructure and community development; social integration, social security and national solidarity; tourism; youth empowerment, sports and recreation; Mauritius Meteorological Services; NDRRMC; Environmental Police; Forestry Service; Renewable Energy Agency; Land Drainage Authority; Rodrigues; Rodrigues Regional Assembly; Statistics Mauritius; Outer Islands Development Corporation; Wastewater Management Authority; and Solid Waste Management Division.

Table 1: Key policies and frameworks for DRR and CCA

Main policies/frameworks for DRR	Purpose	Timeframe
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management	Establishes institutions and mechanisms for DRRM, detailing governance, roles and responsibilities at the national and local level.	2016
(DRRM) Act	Defines the approach, the actors engaged and the overall focus of DRRM efforts in the country.	2020–2030
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) Policy	Maps out the disaster context and governance structure, and defines overall vision and objectives.	2020–2030
National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM) Strategic Framework	Practical and detailed implementation of the DRRM Strategic Framework through 189 actions.	2020–2030
Main policies/frameworks for CCA	Purpose	Timeframe
Climate Change Act	Establishes the policy and institutional arrangement for the national and sub-national response to climate change.	2021
Updated Nationally Determined Contribution	Details commitments of Mauritius for CCA and mitigation.	2021
Updated National Climate Change Adaptation Policy Framework	Focuses on the potential of nature-based solutions for adaptation and provides a new policy orientation in key adaptation sectors to build resilience.	2021
National Adaptation Plan (NAP)	Identifies and prioritizes the adaptation needs of Mauritius. It includes sectors such as health, infrastructure, bridges and culverts, DRR flood-prone areas and coastal zones.	Under development
Other relevant policies		
• Environment Protection Act (2002) • Mauritius Vision 2030 • Mauritius Resilience Strategy (2019) • Marshall Plan Against Poverty Vol 1 and 2 (2016) • Mauritius Sustainable Finance Framework (2023) • Strategic Plan for the Food Crop, Livestock and Forestry Sectors (2016–2020) • National Biodiversity Strategy and Action Plan (2017–2025) • Master Plan on Environment (2020–2030) • Integrated Coastal Zone Management Framework (2010) • Master Plan for the Development of Water Resources in the Republic of Mauritius (2012) • Land Drainage Master Plan (2021–2030) • Guidelines for Climate Change Adaptation Strategy, Coastal Setback (2016)		

Source: Information on DRR policies were extracted from UNDRR (2024). The rest are compiled by the author.

Our analysis did not assess if the coordination mechanisms for DRR and CCA outlined above are operational or effective in coordinating DRR and CCA actions.

3

Climate and disaster budget-tagging reforms and expenditure reviews in Mauritius

Mauritius has conducted disaster and climate expenditure reviews⁵ and taken steps towards introducing routine climate budget tagging. In 2016, Mauritius conducted a Public Environment Expenditure Review (PEER), followed in 2018 by the Tracking Public Sector Environment Expenditure (TPSEE) project which aimed to establish a process for the annual reporting of climate-related expenditure (MOFEPD, 2018). More recently, the Ministry of Finance has been working with AFD on introducing routine GBT.

3.1 Tracking Public Sector Environment Expenditure (TPSEE) project

The TPSEE approach includes adaptation and mitigation expenditure, with DRR only considered to the extent it overlaps with CCA. Four levels of climate relevance were used: “high”, “medium”, “low” and “no relevance”. No weighting system was applied. Tagging was applied manually and an environment and climate change data-collection template was developed, supported by guidance notes, to facilitate data collection from line ministries.

The template included the Vote, the sub-head, total budget for the sub-head, CCA and mitigation expenditure by level of relevance and total environment expenditure. Training on the approach was provided to over 110 officials from across government who are responsible for environment and climate change expenditure.⁶

Expenditure estimates based on the national budget for the budget year 2017–2018, show that climate public expenditure for Mauritius was 2.25% of GDP (gross domestic product), with 77% channelled towards adaptation and 23% to mitigation. TPSEE was intended to be carried out annually and integrated into the Integrated Financial Management System (IFMIS). Reporting templates on environment and climate change expenditure were therefore developed as an appendix for the annual national budget document. However, since the first TPSEE report published in 2018, progress has stalled and the process has not yet been integrated into the annual budget process.

5 This includes the development of the 2015 Public Investment Planning and Financing Strategies for Disaster Risk Reduction, which identify the amount of public DRM and CCA expenditure based on national budget data. For the 2013–2014 budget period, principal DRM and CCA expenditure allocations were 4% of the national budget. For more information see UNISDR (2015).

6 Participating ministries in the training include those responsible for education; technology, communications and innovation; finance and economic development; defense and Rodrigues; health and quality of life; blue economy, marine resources, fisheries and shipping; social security and the environment; Statistics Mauritius; tourism; agro-industry and food security; energy and public utilities; public infrastructure and land transport; housing and lands; local government and outer islands; office of the Accountant General; and the National Development Unit.

3.2 Expenditure analysis for disaster risk management

Mauritius has conducted an expenditure analysis for disaster risk management (DRM), supported by UNDRR, formerly known as the United Nations International Strategy for Disaster Reduction (UNISDR). The approach applied the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Development Assistance Committee (DAC) disaster markers and made use of three disaster-relevant categories: “principal”, “significant” and “not relevant/marked”. No weighting system was applied. In addition, it categorized relevant DRM expenditure as “prevention/mitigation”, “preparedness”, “response” and “reconstruction”.⁷

The analysis covered recurrent expenditure from the programme-based budget for 2012–2016 and the public investment sector programme budget for 2012–2018.⁸ The process included a desk review, complemented by consultations with key government stakeholders.⁹ The expenditure analysis for 2013–2014 estimates DRM expenditure to be around 10% of the national budget¹⁰ and 15% of the capital budget.¹¹ The expenditure analysis was a one-time study.

3.3 Green budget tagging

The government is currently working with AFD on the project Development of Comprehensive Guidelines and Capacity Building on Green Budgeting and Tagging in Mauritius. The main activities under this project are outlined in Box 1.

The initial GBT system will include tags for CCA, climate change mitigation, DRR and other environmentally favourable expenditure. There are plans to expand the systems to include environmentally harmful activities. The approach builds on the OECD DAC Rio markers and includes principal and significant expenditure, with corresponding weights of 100% and 50%. The methodology will be piloted in selected ministries, departments and agencies (Linpico, 2024).

The DCBT team had a working session with the GBT consultants to explore opportunities for harmonizing the two methodological approaches. Further recommendations to strengthen coordination with DRR and CCA have been provided in the DCBT guidelines.

7 The four categories should total 100%.

8 The full period covered in the study was 2010 to 2016. However, from 2015 onwards, the analysis is based on planned expenditure. The types of analysis provided varies, probably due to data availability, with most analysis focused on the 2013 to 2014 period.

9 Consultations were held with MOFEPD, NDRRMC, Ministry of Local Government, Ministry of Environment and Sustainable Development; and the Ministry of Public Infrastructure.

10 The recurrent budget makes use of 2013 actual expenditure and 2014 planned expenditure.

11 For more information see UNISDR (2015).

Box 1:**Main activities under the AFD Green Budget Tagging project**

- Develop national comprehensive guidelines on green budgeting and tagging exercises;
- Produce a green budget reporting proforma/template to assist all ministries and departments to conduct their green reporting;
- Conduct a pilot case for one or two ministries and/or departments;
- Conduct capacity-building and workshops, including training of trainers; and
- Advise on a system or mechanism to ensure proper reporting and validation across all ministries and departments.

3.4 Other ongoing initiatives

To support the planning, budgeting, monitoring and reporting of climate expenditure, there are other related ongoing initiatives at the level of government. These include:

- Developing a green taxonomy for Mauritius with the assistance of the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and the UK government.
- Setting up an online Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) registry platform – the MauNDC Registry – under the Nationally

Appropriate Mitigation Actions for Low Carbon Island Development Strategy (NAMA) project. This is designed to allow for reporting on: outcomes (including mitigation, adaptation and cross-cutting outcomes); interventions (measures) to be linked to the achievement of outcomes; indicators (to track the implementation of the interventions, outcomes and sustainable development); and support needed and received (financial, technical, capacity building and transparency related) towards the achievement of interventions and outcomes.

4

Methodology, scope and process

4.1 Methodology for the expenditure analysis

The expenditure analysis applied the DCBT methodology developed by UNDRR and IIED (UNDRR, 2023). This is a coordinated budget-tagging approach that addresses both DRR and CCA. The methodology builds on the OECD DAC climate and disaster markers, to provide a basic standard international approach. In consultation with the Ministry of Finance, the methodology was tailored to meet the priorities of Mauritius and further informed by broader consultations with relevant spending ministries, agencies and departments. Priorities identified by the Ministry of Finance include:

- Understanding how DRR can be better coordinated and integrated into ongoing GBT reforms;
- Understanding how disaster response expenditure can be monitored and reported as part of the budget tagging system; and
- Providing recommendations for the institutionalization of budget tagging for DRR and CCA in Mauritius.

Climate change mitigation was not included, as it is part of ongoing work on GBT.

In line with the priorities mentioned above, the DCBT approach for Mauritius made use of three tags: “DRR”, “CCA” and “disaster response”.¹² In the standard methodology, the degrees of climate relevance included “principal”, “significant” and “marginal” expenditure, with respective weights of 100%, 50% and 1%. During the consultation process, the need for an additional category was identified and “low” DRR and CCA relevance has therefore been added. The weight applied is flexible and can range from between 10% and 30%. During the consultation process, this range was found to be the most appropriate for Mauritius. The weights used are conservative compared to the UNDP Climate Public Expenditure and Institutional Review (CPEIR) guidelines where low-relevance expenditure is given a weight of 25% to 49% (UNDP, 2015). A summary of the degrees of relevance and respective weights used for Mauritius are provided in Table 2. Due to separate tags for DRR and CCA, to ensure there is no double counting, total DRR and/or CCA expenditure is calculated as overlapping expenditure, plus DRR-only expenditure, plus CCA-only expenditure.

12 The disaster response tag is an add-on to the standard methodology and was included to capture post-disaster expenditure in the national budget.

Table 2: Degrees and weights for DRR and CCA relevance

Level	Description	Justification	Weight
2	Principal	A budget line will be “principal” if it directly and explicitly contributes to DRR or CCA. Were it not for the DRR or CCA objective, the activity would be unlikely to be approved for funding.	100%
1	Significant	A budget line will score “significant” if the DRR or CCA objective is explicitly stated and the budget line helps meet those objectives but they were not its primary motivation. It might be funded anyway, but the DRR or CCA objectives may help to tip the balance in the search to secure funding.	50%
L	Low	A budget line will score “low” if the DRR and CCA objective has indirect adaptation and mitigation benefits.	10–30%
M	Marginal	A budget line that only marginally contributes to DRR or CCA. These objectives may not be stated explicitly or may only be a small concern. Funding would definitely be approved regardless of any contribution to DRR or CCA objectives, but the DRR/CCA relevance may justify some additional funding.	1%
R	Response	Captures the post-disaster cost of the unbudgeted response to disasters which technically do not fall under the definition of DRR. It also captures longer-term recovery, rehabilitation and reconstruction, which may continue for many years after a disaster and can end up being funded through annual capital budget allocations.	100%
0	None	The budget line does not target DRR and/or CCA in any significant way.	0%

Source: UNDRR (2023)

4.2 Data analysis and consultation process

The analysis covered the 2023–2024 and 2024–2025 budget years, making use of estimates as provided in the 2024–25 appropriated budget, publicly available on the Ministry of Finance website. This was complemented by additional budget information provided by the Ministry of Finance on the National Environment Fund, Project Development Fund and the newly established Climate and Sustainability Fund. All

expenditures in the appropriated budget were scanned for DRR- and CCA-relevant expenditure. Tagging for most ministries was done at the sub-head level, although for the Ministry of Tourism, tagging was done at the activity level.¹³ For the special funds covered, tagging was done at the “details of payments” level.¹⁴

An initial desk review was followed by consultations with relevant ministries, departments and agencies. This included a project kick-off meeting, designed to raise awareness of the project, and planned bilateral consultations with relevant ministries,

¹³ For tourism there was insufficient information to apply the tags at the sub-head level and the tagging was therefore done at the activity level.

¹⁴ Special funds include the National Resilience Fund, Lotto Fund, Poverty Reduction Fund, National Environment Fund, Projects Development Fund and Climate and Sustainability Fund. The latter three funds used data received from MOFEPD. The rest of the special funds used information from Annex C of the appropriated budget for 2024–2025.

departments and agencies. The latter took the form of working sessions, with the following main objectives:

- Share the DCBT methodology to enable selected government ministries, departments and agencies to identify and estimate their DRR- and CCA-relevant expenditure in their respective budgets;
- Obtain inputs on how best to coordinate and integrate DRR and CCA into the national budget process, in line with ongoing public financial management reforms; and
- Raise awareness and capacity on the implementation of integrated approaches to DRR and CCA.

Supporting information was provided to respective ministries, departments and agencies before the meeting. These included:

- A short guide with step-by-step instructions on applying the DCBT methodology, with the link to the full DCBT guide and taxonomy;

- Excel templates tailored to each ministry for the expenditure analysis, using information extracted from the 2024–2025 appropriated budget; and
- A reference table, which provides a list of the broad areas of expenditure that contribute to DRR and/or CCA and related indicative examples of action areas and suggested scores.

The inputs received during the working sessions were consolidated as part of the expenditure analysis presented in Section 5.

The consultation process engaged over 180 officials. A breakdown of the number of officials by government institution is provided in Table 3. The working sessions were interactive and required the active participation of officials. The DCBT methodology, which was explained in detail by the project team, was easily understood by most officials. A representative from the Ministry of Finance was present at all meetings and working sessions held.

Table 3: Number of people engaged in the consultation process for this study

Working sessions	Number of people engaged
Accountant General's Office (two meetings)	7
Ministry of Environment, Solid Waste Management and Climate Change ^a	11
Ministry of Local Government and Disaster Risk Management (MLGDRM) ^b including NDRRMC, Fire and Rescue Service and Mauritius Meteorological Services	11
Ministry of Health and Wellness ^c	12
Ministry of Gender Equality and Family Welfare	20
Ministry of National Infrastructure and Community Development (including National Development Unit and Land Drainage Authority)	28
Ministry of Tourism	6
Expenditure analysis for DRR and CCA: Ministry of Land Transport and Light Rail	12
Ministry of Blue Economy, Marine Resources, Fisheries and Shipping	17
Ministry of Agro-Industry and Food Security	28
Ministry of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity	23
Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities including the Energy Efficiency Management Office (EEMO), Mauritius Renewable Energy Agency (MARENA), Wastewater Management Authority (WMA) and Water Resources Unit	7
Total number of people engaged as part of bilateral consultations with the relevant ministries, departments and agencies	182
Project kick-off meeting	35
Debrief meeting, Ministry of Finance	41

Note: The figures provided exclude the three members of the project team.

- a The Ministry of Environment, Solid Waste Management and Climate Change engaged as the lead agency for climate change policy.
- b MLGDRM engaged as the lead agency for DRR policy.
- c The Ministry of Gender Equality and Family Welfare engaged to better understand how climate change and DRR are coordinated with gender.

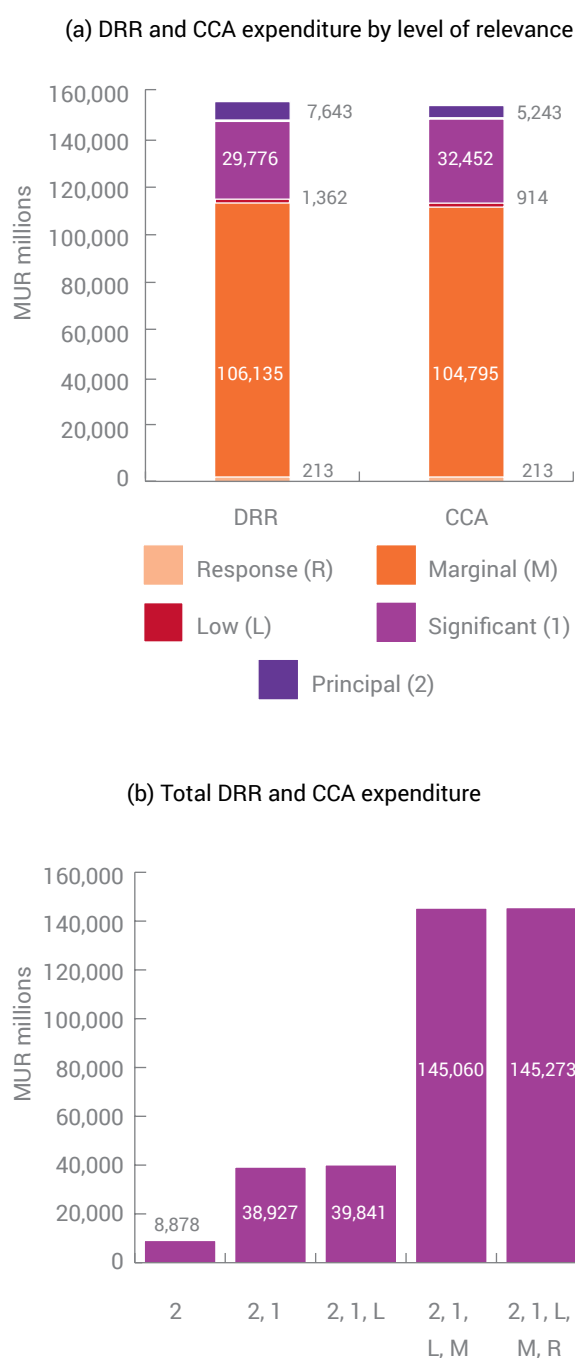
5 Key findings

This section presents the key findings from the expenditure analysis which makes use of the DCBT methodology. Results are presented as the average for the 2023–2024 and 2024–2025 budgets. Unweighted DRR and CCA expenditure is first analyzed, to better understand the type of expenditure that contributes to both. However, as the inclusion of marginal and low expenditure may dominate expenditure trends, weighted expenditure is also presented. All expenditure is presented in Mauritian rupees (MUR).

5.1 Unweighted disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation expenditure

Total unweighted DRR and/or CCA expenditure is measured as overlapping DRR and CCA expenditure, plus DRR only and CCA only. Total unweighted DRR and CCA expenditure using the narrow definition of “principal” and “significant” was MUR 38.927 billion, 15.1% of total expenditure by Vote and 5.2% of GDP. Adding “low-relevance” expenditure increased the total slightly to MUR 39.84 billion. Total DRR and CCA expenditure including marginal expenditure was MUR 145.06 billion, 56.1% of total expenditure by Vote and 19.3% of GDP as summarized in Table 4. This high value is driven by large expenditure programmes which only make a small or indirect contribution to DRR or CCA, which further motivates the use of a weighted system.

Figure 1: DRR and CCA expenditure, average unweighted



There is large overlap between DRR and CCA expenditure as shown in Figure 2. For “principal” and “significant” expenditure, the overlap was 93%, with just 3% of total relevant expenditure counting as DRR only and 4% as CCA only. When “low” and “marginal” expenditure is considered, overlapping DRR and CCA expenditure increased to 99%, with 1% accounting for DRR only. The main spending

areas where DRR-only expenditure lay was for contingency funds and special funds which have some expenditure related to DRR and the health and transport sector. Further analysis of DRR-only expenditure is available in Figure 3 and Figure 4. The results indicate that one tag for DRR and CCA may be appropriate for Mauritius. However, institutional factors should also be considered.

Figure 2: DRR only, CCA only and overlapping expenditure, average unweighted

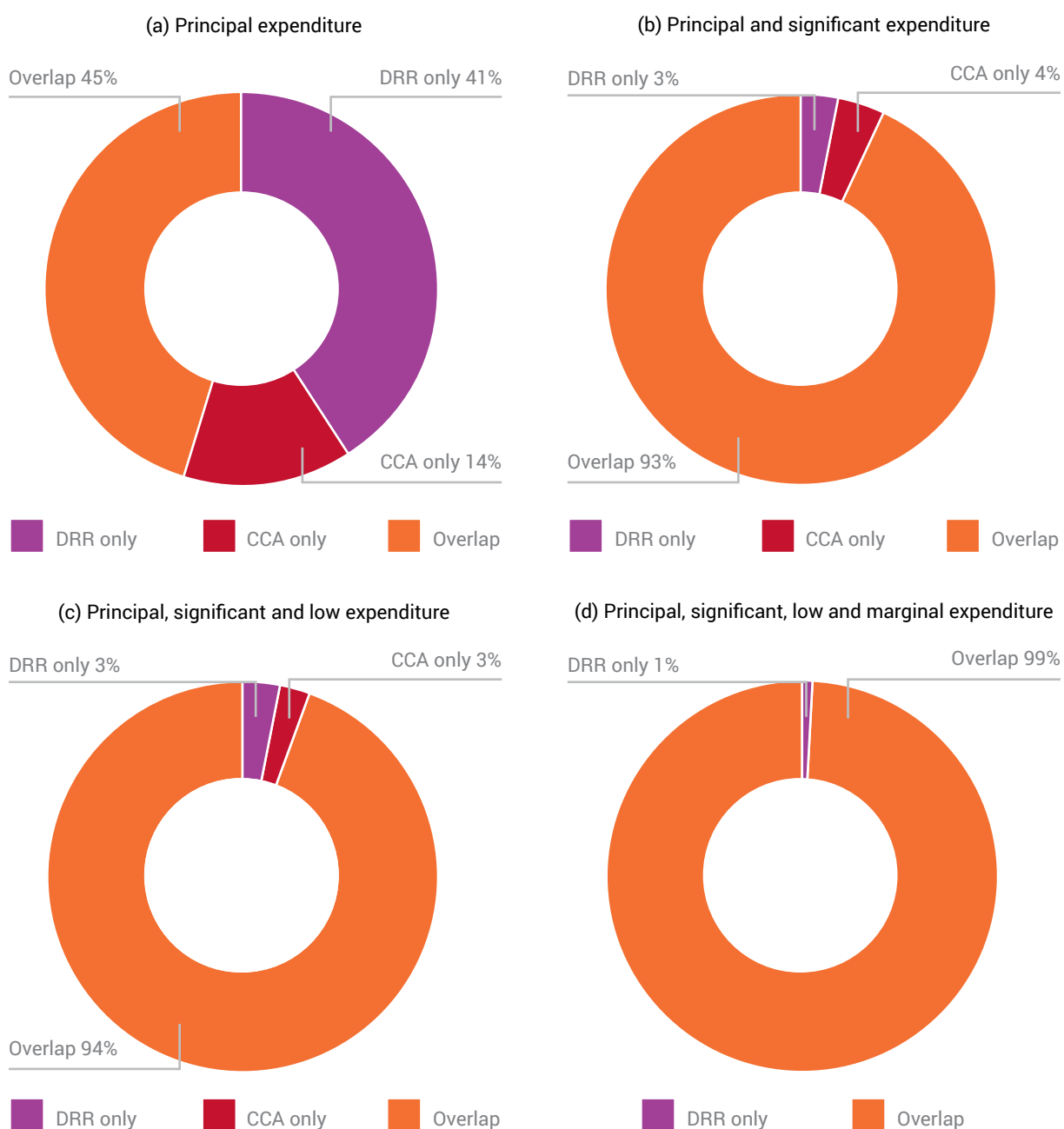
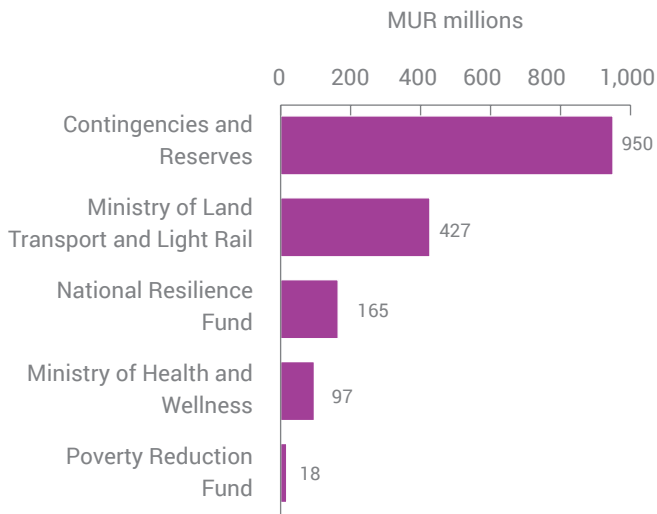
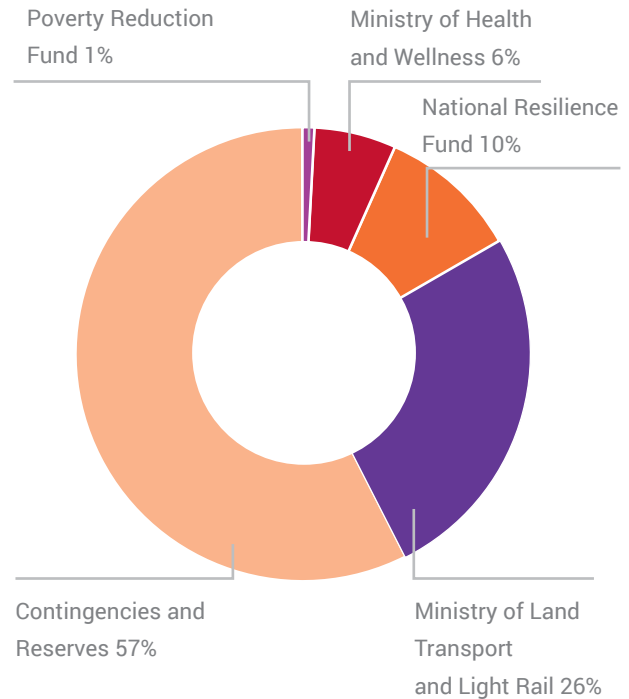


Figure 3: DRR only expenditure for 2, 1, L, M, average unweighted**Figure 4:** Share of DRR only expenditure for 2, 1, L, M, average unweighted**Table 4:** Summary of total DRR and CCA expenditure, average unweighted

	(2)	(2, 1)	(2, 1, L)	(2, 1, L, M)	(2, 1, L, M, R)
DRR (MUR millions)	7,643	37,419	38,781	144,916	145,128
CCA (MUR millions)	5,243	37,694	38,608	143,403	143,616
Response (R) (MUR millions)	213				
Overlapping DRR and CCA (MUR millions)	4,008	36,187	37,549	143,259	
DRR only (MUR millions)	3,635	1,232	1,232	1,657	
CCA only (MUR millions)	1,235	1,507	1,059	144	
Total DRR and CCA (MUR millions)	8,878	38,927	39,841	145,060	145,273
Overlap %	45	93.0	94.2	98.8	
Total DRR and CCA % expenditure by vote*	3.4	15.1	15.4	56.1	56.2
Total DRR and CCA % GDP**	1.2	5.2	5.3	19.3	19.3

Note: *Total expenditure by Vote is taken as the average for 2023 of MUR 227 billion and 2024 of MUR 289.8 billion.

**Total GDP is taken as the average for 2023 of MUR 704 billion and 2024 of MUR 798.5 billion as provided in the Mid-term Expenditure Framework.

5.2 Weighted disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation expenditure

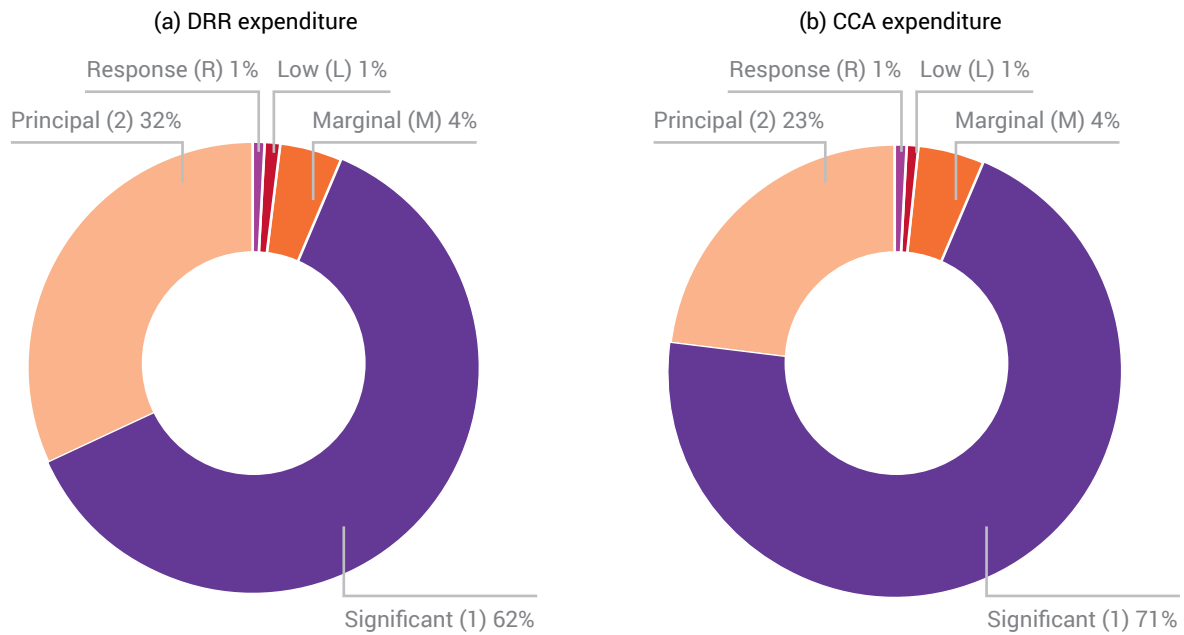
Total weighted “principal” and “significant” DRR expenditure was MUR 22.5 billion, 8.7% of total expenditure by Vote and 3% of GDP. DRR expenditure increased to MUR 23.9 billion with the inclusion of “low” and “marginal” expenditure. The latter two categories (low and marginal) of DRR relevance accounted for roughly 6% of total DRR expenditure, well below the 10% threshold set to ensure that low and marginal expenditure does not dominate expenditure trends.

Total weighted “principal” and “significant” CCA expenditure was MUR 21.5 billion, 8.3% of total expenditure by Vote and 2.86% of GDP. Total CCA expenditure increased to MUR 22.7 billion when “low” and “marginal” expenditure were considered, accounting for roughly 5% of total CCA expenditure. Similar to DRR expenditure, the weights used were appropriate.

DRR and CCA expenditure was spread across 34 ministries, departments and agencies and special funds as shown in Appendices 1 and 2. Figure 7 shows that the top institutions responsible for DRR and/or CCA expenditure are the Ministry of Health and Wellness, police service, Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities, Projects Development Fund, National Infrastructure, Ministry of Agro-Industry and Food Security, Climate and Sustainability Fund, and the Mauritius Fire and Rescue Service.

Figure 5: Total DRR and CCA expenditure by level of relevance, average weighted

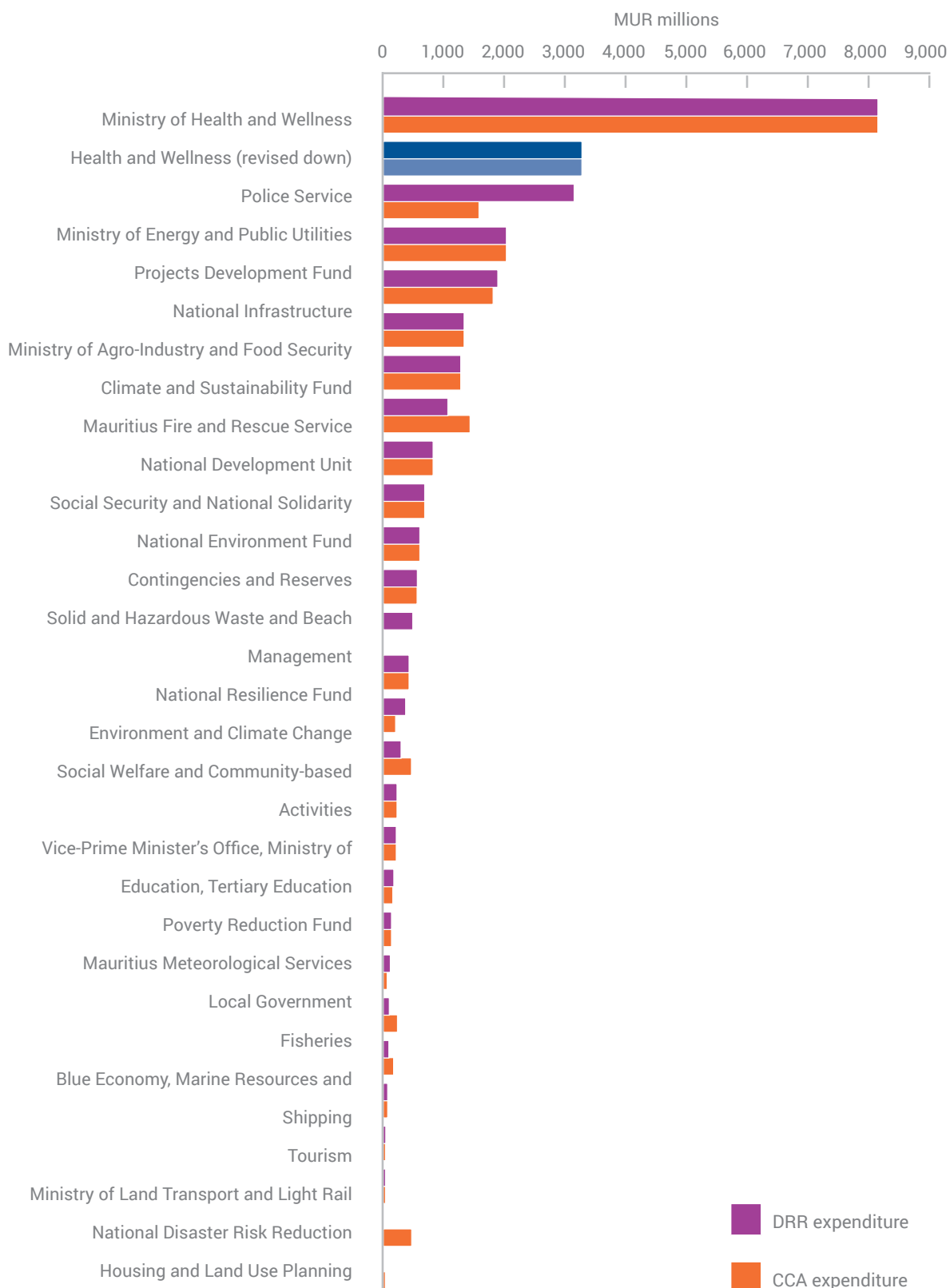


Figure 6: DRR and CCA expenditure by level of relevance, average weighted**Table 5:** Summary of DRR and CCA expenditure estimates, average weighted

	Principal (2)	Significant (1)	Low (L)	Marginal (M)	Response (R)	(2, 1)	(2, 1, L)	(2, 1, L, M)	2, 1, L, M, R)
DRR expenditure									
(MUR millions)	7,643	14,888	309	1,067	213	22,531	22,841	23,908	24,121
DRR % total expenditure by Vote*	2.96					8.72	8.84	9.25	9.33
DRR % GDP**	1.02					3.00	3.04	3.18	3.21
CCA expenditure									
(MUR millions)	5,243	16,226	220	1,054	213	21,468	21,688	22,7423	22,955
CCA % total expenditure by Vote*	2.03					8.31	8.39	8.80	8.88
CCA % GDP**	0.70					2.86	2.89	3.03	3.06

Note: *Total expenditure by Vote is taken as the average for 2023 of MUR 227 billion and 2024 of MUR 289.8 billion.

**Total GDP is taken as the average for 2023 of MUR 704 billion and 2024 of MUR 798.5 billion as provided in the Mid-term Expenditure Framework.

Figure 7: Main institutions responsible for DRR and/or CCA expenditure, average weighted

Note: Blue is used to indicate revised estimates for the Ministry of Health and Wellness.

The high amount of climate-change expenditure from the Ministry of Health and Wellness highlights the growing impacts of climate change on the health sector. During the consultation process, the Ministry of Health and Wellness outlined the increase of climate-sensitive diseases, as well as the indirect negative effect that poor food security and nutrition are having on addressing non-communicable diseases. In the Mauritius updated NDC (Government of Mauritius, 2021), health is identified as a priority sector for adaptation and will be a central component in the National Adaptation Plan (NAP) currently under development.

Health expenditure by sub-head was classified as “significant”, “low” or “marginal” relevance to DRR and/or CCA. We therefore did additional analysis, reported in Appendix 3, to see the result on expenditure trends of using a lower level of relevance and corresponding weight for expenditure from the Ministry of Health and Wellness. To do this, all “significant” expenditure with a weight of 50% was revised down to “low”, with a corresponding weight of 20%. This results in a reduction of respective expenditure by roughly MUR 5 billion.¹⁵ Even with this change, the Ministry of Health and Wellness remained one of the key institutions for DRR and CCA, with the highest expenditure as shown in Figure 7.

The police service was found to have relevant DRR and/or CCA expenditure related to emergency rescue, as well as coastal and maritime surveillance, search and rescue. The Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities is responsible for water and wastewater services, which have become increasingly important in the context of climate change and increasing disasters given water scarcity,¹⁶ as well as contamination due to natural disasters.

It needs to be highlighted that the expenditure analysis, including the level of relevance and associated weightages reported are largely based on the inputs provided by the relevant ministries during the in-country mission held in August 2024. The results provide important insights, however, given the subjective nature of the approach, which is relevant to most tagging methodologies, the DRR and CCA tagging process could be further refined and supported by the establishment of a DCBT technical working group. For example, there were discussions during the consultation process and among the project team on the inclusion of social protection which increases the resilience of vulnerable groups, including the elderly. The DCBT technical working group could help address these types of questions, by reviewing related tags and weights and building consistency in the tagging process. Additional training for relevant spending ministries would also help build further understanding of DCBT.

15 Total DRR expenditure from the Ministry of Health and Wellness fell from 8,131,550 to 3,260,090 and CCA expenditure fell from MUR 8,130,580 to MUR 3,259,120, bringing the total DRR expenditure down by 20% to MUR 19,249,132 and total CCA expenditure to MUR 18,083,588.

16 Use of integrated water management systems.

5.3 Disaster-response expenditure

Average disaster response expenditure was MUR 213 million for 2023–2024, 1% of total DRR and CCA expenditure. Information shared by the Ministry of Finance showed that actual disaster response expenditure was MUR 1.037 billion.¹⁷ The DCBT methodology therefore only captured 20% of disaster response expenditure. This finding highlights the limitations of manual budget tagging for tracking and reporting on disaster response expenditure.¹⁸

The institutions responsible for disaster response expenditure identified in the budget include the National Resilience Fund and the Projects Development Fund.

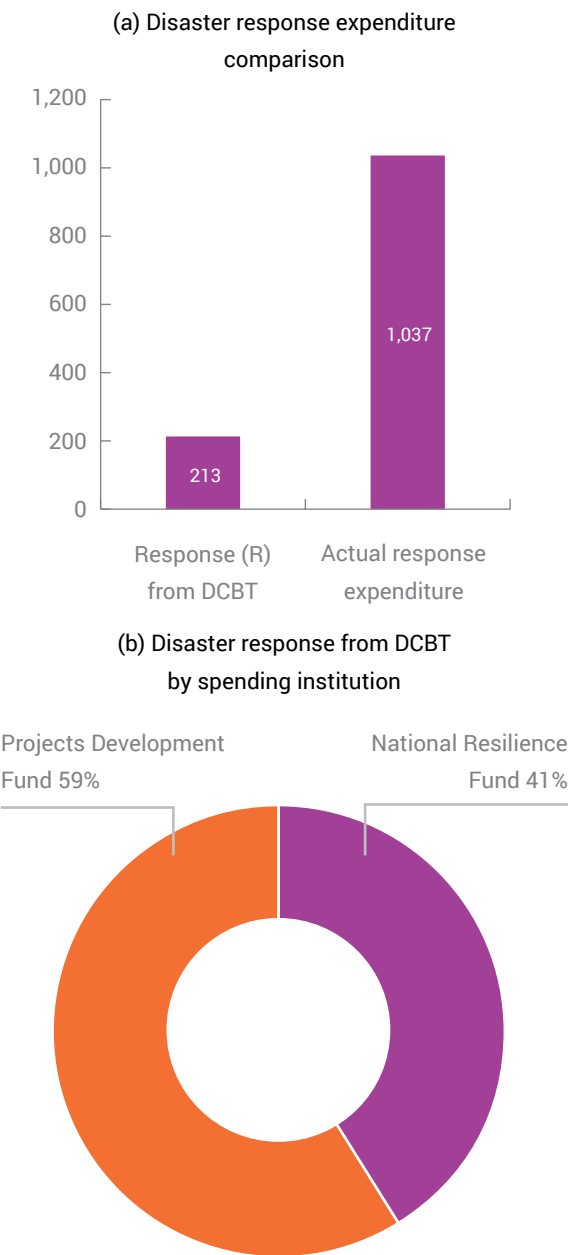
5.4 Comparison with other estimates

The DRR and CCA expenditure estimates are compared with other expenditure estimates as shown in Figure 9, although there are limits to this assessment due to differences in coverage, time period and methodologies applied.

The UNISDR (2015) review of Mauritius applied the OECD DAC disaster markers to the national budget and found average DRM expenditure for 2013–2014 was 10% of the total budget. This included unweighted principal and significant DRM expenditure. This is close to – although

higher than – our estimate for DRR and disaster response of 9.33%. Differences in the estimates are partly explained by differences in the methodology as the UNISDR review only had three levels of disaster relevance and that it did not make use of weights.

Figure 8: Disaster response expenditure



17 Information on actual disaster response expenditure was compiled by MOFEPD through a separate process.

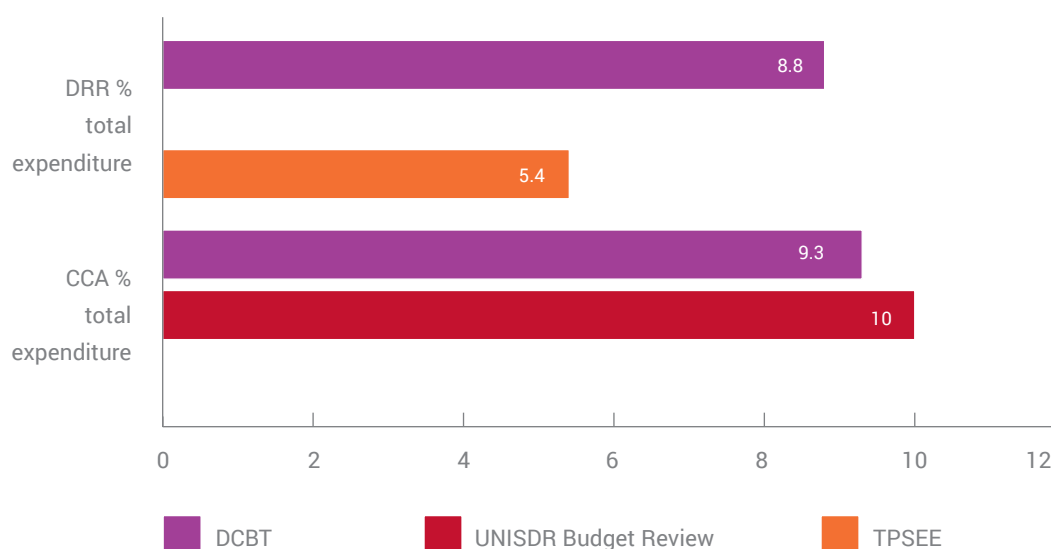
18 Looking at annual disaster response expenditure does not make much difference to the result. Disaster response expenditure was MUR 110,000,000 in 2023, 10.6% of total disaster response expenditure and MUR 315,000,000 in 2024, 30.37% of total disaster response expenditure.

The TPSEE study covered CCA and mitigation and made use of the categories of “high”, “medium” and “low” climate relevance. For 2017–2018, total unweighted climate change expenditure was MUR 10.289 billion, of which 77% was for CCA. Total CCA expenditure was MUR 7.951 billion, 5.4% of total expenditure and 1.66% of GDP. Our estimates for adaptation of 8.8% of total expenditure and 3.03% of GDP are higher compared to the TPSEE study. This could partly be explained by differences in the methodologies, as DCBT includes “marginal”

expenditure. It could also be a reflection of the higher priority or mainstreaming of climate change into sectoral programmes and budgets (for example, expenditure from the Ministry of Health and Wellness).¹⁹

Although the expenditure estimates for DRR and CCA from previous studies are not directly comparable, we can infer that the estimates obtained from DCBT for both DRR and CCA are within reasonable bounds.

Figure 9: Comparison of DCBT expenditure estimates with other studies



¹⁹ Our analysis did not include expenditure trends over time and further analysis would be required.

6

Institutionalization of disaster risk reduction and climate change adaptation budget tagging in Mauritius

Mauritius is in the process of introducing green budget tagging, led by the Ministry of Finance. There are plans to integrate DRR as part of the process. Green and disaster budget tagging is the institutionalization of the process for identifying, classifying, weighting and marking DRR, climate and/or environment relevant expenditure in the government's budget system, enabling the estimation, monitoring and tracking of related expenditure as part of the budget process (UNDP, 2019). Budget tagging initiatives have increasingly been adopted by countries given the cross-sectoral nature of DRR and/or climate change expenditure which is spread across a number of

ministries, departments and agencies. At least 32 countries globally have introduced DRR and/or climate budget tagging reforms.

A roadmap and guidelines on green budget tagging have been developed. The roadmap defines the objectives for green budget tagging in Mauritius, the methodology and the timeline for a phased approach to the roll-out of the reform over a period of three years. The guidelines provide detailed instructions for all relevant ministries, departments and agencies on the application of GDBT as part of the annual budget process.

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Appendix 1.

Disaster risk reduction expenditure by institution, weighted

Table 6: DRR expenditure by institution, average 2023 and 2024, weighted

MUR thousands	2	1	L	M	R	Total
Ministry of Health and Wellness		8,119,100	11,480	970		8,131,550
Police Service	3,131,200					3,131,200
Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities		2,006,525	9,900	212		2,016,637
Projects Development Fund	1,657,000			93,088	125,000	1,875,088
National Infrastructure		1,114,400	198,510	7,543		1,320,453
Ministry of Agro-Industry and Food Security		1,263,633		1,502		1,265,135
Climate and Sustainability Fund	646,150	406,950				1,053,100
Mauritius Fire and Rescue Service	810,000					810,000
National Development Unit	672,000					672,000
Social Security and National Solidarity				592,090		592,090
National Environment Fund	267,750	282,560		628		550,938
Contingencies and Reserves		475,000				475,000
Solid and Hazardous Waste and Beach Management		414,625				414,625
National Resilience Fund	177,500	60,250		33,300	87,500	358,550
Environment and Climate Change	111,550	171,225				282,775
Social Welfare and Community-Based Activities		216,500				216,500
Vice-Prime Minister's Office, Ministry of Education, Tertiary Education				203,705		203,705
Poverty Reduction Fund	17,500	146,250				163,750
Mauritius Meteorological Services	125,500					125,500
Local Government		53,193		52,836		106,029
Fisheries			89,575			89,575
Blue Economy, Marine Resources and Shipping		80,575		1,590		82,165
Tourism		62,650				62,650
Ministry of Land Transport and Light Rail				31,421		31,421
National Disaster Risk Reduction	27,150					27,150
Housing and Land Use Planning				20,600		20,600
Rodrigues, Outer Islands and Territorial Integrity		13,375		2,512		15,887
Social Integration				9,430		9,430
Gender Equality and Family Welfare				5,700		5,700
Ministry of Labour, Human Resource Development and Training				4,993		4,993
Ministry of Arts and Cultural Heritage				2,923		2,923
Valuation Department				1,458		1,458
Foreign Affairs, Regional Integration and International Trade		1,138				1,138
Ministry of Industrial Development, SMEs and Cooperatives				880		880
Total						24,120,592

Appendix 2.

Climate change adaptation expenditure by institution, weighted

Table 7: CCA expenditure by institution, average 2023 and 2024, weighted

MUR thousands	2	1	L	M	R	Total
Ministry of Health and Wellness		8,119,100	11,480			8,130,580
Ministry of Energy and Public Utilities		2,006,525	9,900	212		2,016,637
Projects Development Fund	1,500,000	78,500		94,338	125,000	1,797,838
Police Service		1,565,600				1,565,600
Climate and Sustainability Fund	1,382,550	36,250		50		1,418,850
National Infrastructure		1,114,400	198,510	7,543		1,320,453
Ministry of Agro-Industry and Food Security		1,263,633		1,502		1,265,135
Mauritius Fire and Rescue Service	810,000					810,000
National Development Unit	672,000					672,000
Social Security and National Solidarity				592,090		592,090
National Environment Fund	259,450	286,710		628		546,788
Housing and Land Use Planning		446,275		11,675		457,950
Environment and Climate Change	454,000					454,000
Solid and Hazardous Waste and Beach Management		414,625				414,625
Fisheries		223,938				223,938
Social Welfare and Community-Based Activities		216,500				216,500
Vice-Prime Minister's Office, Ministry of Education, Tertiary Education				203,705		203,705
National Resilience Fund		72,250		33,195	87,500	192,945
Blue Economy, Marine Resources and Shipping		160,050				160,050
Poverty Reduction Fund		146,250				146,250
Mauritius Meteorological Services	125,500					125,500
Tourism		62,650		303		62,953
Local Government				53,900		53,900
National Disaster Risk Reduction	27,150					27,150
Ministry of Land Transport and Light Rail				27,148		27,148
Rodrigues, Outer Islands and Territorial Integrity	9,750	12,500		2,557		24,807
Social Integration				9,430		9,430
Gender Equality and Family Welfare				5,700		5,700
Ministry of Labour, Human Resource Development and Training				4,993		4,993
Ministry of Arts and Cultural Heritage				2,923		2,923
Foreign Affairs, Regional Integration and International Trade	2,275					2,275
Valuation Department				1,458		1,458
Ministry of Industrial Development, SMEs and Cooperatives				880		880
Total						22,955,048

Appendix 3. Expenditure estimates for the Ministry of Health and Wellness revised down

Given the high estimates for DRR and CCA relevant expenditure from the health sector, additional analysis was done to determine expenditure trends, when a lower level of DRR and CCA relevance is given to health expenditure. All relevant sub-heads that were classified as significant were revised down to low relevance with a corresponding weight of 20%. The results from the analysis are presented in Table 8 below. Total DRR and CCA expenditure is reduced by 20% and the overall contribution to GDP for DRR and/or CCA would be reduced by about 0.67%. However, the Ministry of Health and Wellness remains the top institution responsible for DRR and CCA relevant expenditure as shown in Figure 7.

Table 8: Expenditure estimates for health (revised down), weighted

MUR thousands	Principal (2)	Significant (1)	Low (L)	Marginal (M)	Response (R)	Total (2, 1, L, M, R)
DRR-relevant health expenditure		8,119,100	11,480	970		8,131,550
DRR-relevant health expenditure (revised down)			3,259,120	970		3,260,090
CCA-relevant health expenditure		8,119,100	11,480			8,130,580
CCA-relevant health expenditure (revised down)			3,259,120			3,259,120
Total DRR expenditure	7,643,000	14,888,000	309,000	1,067,000	213,000	24,121,000
Total DRR expenditure (revised down)	7,643,000	6,768,848	3,557,105	1,067,380	213,000	19,249,132
CCA expenditure	5,243,000	16,226,000	220,000	1,054,000	213,000	22,955,000
Total CCA expenditure (revised down)	5,243,000	8,106,655	3,467,530	1,054,228	213,000	18,083,588

Appendix 4. Overview of institutional arrangements for disaster risk reduction

Table 9: Overview of institutional arrangements for DRR

National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council

Membership includes:

- (a) the Minister, who shall be the Chairperson;
- (b) the Secretary to Cabinet and Head of the Civil Service;
- (c) the Commissioner of Police;
- (d) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry;
- (e) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of agriculture;
- (f) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of civil service;
- (g) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of education;
- (h) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of external affairs;
- (i) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of external communications;
- (j) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of finance;
- (k) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of fisheries;
- (l) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of gender equality;
- (m) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of health;
- (n) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of home affairs;
- (o) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of housing and lands;
- (p) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of local government;
- (q) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of oceanography;
- (r) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of public infrastructure;
- (s) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of public utilities;
- (t) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of social security;
- (u) the supervising officer or a representative of the Ministry responsible for the subject of tourism;
- (v) the Chief Fire Officer, Mauritius Fire and Rescue Service;
- (w) the Director, Mauritius Meteorological Services;
- (x) the Port Master, Mauritius Ports Authority;
- (y) a representative of Business Mauritius;
- (z) a representative of the Mauritius Red Cross Society; and
- (za) a representative of the Mauritius Council of Social Service.

Functions include:

- (a) formulate the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Policy;
- (b) oversee the implementation of the National Strategic Framework and National Plan;
- (c) ensure that Ministries, departments and local authorities have adequate human resources, tools, materials and other resources for the effective implementation of disaster risk reduction and management activities at all levels;
- (d) oversee the implementation of post-disaster recovery and reconstruction activities;
- (e) examine post-disaster review reports carried out by the National Centre and recommend on remedial measures to be taken, if any;
- (f) ensure that disaster risk reduction becomes an integral objective of environment related policies and plans, land use planning, natural resource management, educational plans, social development plans, economic policies, sectoral policies, as well as infrastructure through enforcement of building codes;
- (g) promote research and development and commission studies on disaster risk reduction and management;
- (h) promote regional and international cooperation related to disaster risk reduction and management;
- (i) review the national warning system for multi-hazards;
- (j) formulate policies on relief assistance; and
- (k) where appropriate, advise the Prime Minister to declare a state of disaster.

National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Centre

Functions include:

- (a) act as the main institution in Mauritius for coordinating and monitoring the implementation of disaster risk reduction and management activities as per the National Strategic Framework and National Plan;
- (b) ensure the implementation of the National Strategic Framework and National Plan;
- (c) coordinate and monitor all disaster risk reduction and management activities;
- (d) coordinate and monitor the implementation of the disaster risk reduction and management programmes through community participation and public awareness campaigns;
- (e) work in close collaboration with the Mauritius Meteorological Services, which shall develop and improve warnings and advisories systems for all natural hazards affecting Mauritius;
- (f) implement a national multi-hazard emergency alert system to provide accurate and timely advice to the public and key stakeholders;
- (g) support Ministries, Government departments, local authorities and communities in building capacity for disaster risk reduction and management;
- (h) facilitate and coordinate the conduct of regular trainings, drills and simulation exercises to test the adequacy of disaster response plans;
- (i) undertake and participate in post-disaster reviews, including lessons drawn from previous disasters in disaster preparedness and response plans;
- (j) assist relevant stakeholders to develop an appropriate risk transfer mechanism for post-disaster recovery and rehabilitation purposes;
- (k) collaborate with all relevant stakeholders so that disaster risk reduction and management becomes an integral objective of environment-related policies and plans, sound land use planning, natural resources management, education and social development plans, economic and sectoral policies, as well as infrastructure through enforcement of building codes;
- (l) foster regional and international cooperation in disaster risk reduction management issues, including best practices and sharing of expertise;
- (m) promote research and development and commission studies on disaster risk reduction and management matters;
- (n) publish and disseminate information concerning disaster risk reduction and management; and
- (o) carry out such other activities as may be necessary or expedient for the administration of this Act.

National Crisis Committee

Membership includes:

- (a) the Minister, who shall be the chairperson;
- (b) the Secretary to Cabinet and Head of the Civil Service;
- (c) the Secretary for Home Affairs;
- (d) the supervising officer;
- (e) the Commissioner of Police;
- (f) the Director-General;
- (g) the Chief Fire Officer, Mauritius Fire and Rescue Service;
- (h) the Director of the Mauritius Meteorological Services;
- (i) the Director of SAMU; and
- (j) such other person as the Chairperson may determine.

Functions include:

- (1) The National Crisis Committee shall have all the functions and powers of the National Council and shall take decisive and timely actions through the National Emergency Operations Command to,
 - (a) ensure that general preparedness plans are activated at all levels;
 - (b) safeguard the life of persons in danger, including evacuation of persons at risk;
 - (c) supervise the organization of disaster response operations;
 - (d) provide relief assistance;
 - (e) take appropriate measures during the initial recovery phase; and
 - (f) take such other measures as may be appropriate in the circumstances.
- (2) Notwithstanding any other enactment, the National Crisis Committee may, to safeguard the life of any person, issue, after consultation with the Prime Minister,
 - (a) an order directing any person to remain indoors as long as it is unsafe to venture outside;
 - (b) an order directing any person to evacuate their premises or any public place;
 - (c) an order directing any person in a particular area to be evacuated within a certain specified time;
 - (d) an order directing any person not to venture near rivers, canals, water courses and cliffs;
 - (e) an order directing any person, including any fisherman, not to venture at sea, on beaches or on islets during heavy rainfall or inundation, and to stop any outdoor activity;
 - (f) an order declaring a localised area a disaster or potential disaster area and cause the evacuation and restrict access thereto; and
 - (g) any other order as may be appropriate in the circumstances.

National Emergency Operations Command

Membership includes:

The National Emergency Operations Command shall be a multi-agency with members from the public and private sectors and it shall report to the National Crisis Committee.

Powers of the National Emergency Operations Command:

- a) cause to be closed or diverted any public road which represents a potential risk to road users;
- (b) cause the evacuation, either voluntarily or by using such force as may be necessary, of persons who are at risk;
- (c) cause public facilities such as emergency shelters, educational institutions, stadiums, gymnasiums, parking spaces or any other public place to be used for the purpose of sheltering displaced persons or storage of emergency supplies;
- (d) direct the closure of any underground facilities, subways, underpasses or such other places or facilities as may be necessary; and (e) cause to be deployed such resources.

Disaster Response Unit

Membership includes:

The Disaster Response Unit shall be composed of police officers, who shall be posted on a rotation basis and shall be under the control of the Commanding Officer of the Special Mobile Force.

Source: Extracted from the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act (Government of Mauritius, 2016).

United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction (UNDRR)
7bis Avenue de la Paix, CH1211 Geneva 2, Switzerland
Telephone: +41(0)22 917 89 07-8
E-mail: undrr@un.org
Website: www.undrr.org



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